JACK SENECHAL

ENGINEERING LEAD

Located in Novato, CA
Phone: 415-779-2701
Email: jacksenechal@gmail.com
GitHub: github.com/jacksenechal
LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/jacksenechal

SUMMARY

Hands-on engineering lead with **6+ years leading teams** while staying deep in code, architecture, and review.

- **Builds the delivery machinery, not just the roadmap**: agent-driven "software factories" with harness-enforced SDLC, carrying work from spec to shipped without trading away production quality.
- **Turnaround track record**: rearchitected an unreliable integrations platform for **~100x error reduction** and led a **zero-downtime** Heroku to Google Cloud migration.
- **Rebuilt a DevOps team** after mass departures, then owned its roadmap.
- **Full-stack generalist**: modern web, cloud-native infrastructure, and applied AI/LLM integration across every role.
- **Grew multiple junior engineers into senior SWE and Engineering Manager roles**, while staying accountable for architecture and code quality.

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Independent Consultant · AI-Native Software Delivery

Client engagements | May 2026 - Present | Remote

Scope: designs the delivery process and governance model; owns product and prioritization.

- Running "software factories": agent-driven delivery pipelines that carry engineering work from spec to shipped, with a human owning the product. Speed without fragility: production-quality output over long-horizon iteration, where agentic development typically falls down.
- **Core thesis**: the same DevOps and project-management discipline that makes human teams work is the necessary and sufficient foundation for agent teams, encoded into the harness and context.
- **GitHub as coordination substrate**: issues, PRs, and Projects as the single ledger. Harness-enforced SDLC (independent fresh-context reviewer, green CI, supply-chain scanning, deployment smoke check) so agents move fast without breaking things.
- **Self-improving harness**: orchestration agents run, observe, and refine the process, converging on and shipping their own refinements.
- Governance built into the system: every change passes an independent reviewer, automated testing, supply-chain security scanning, and a deployment verification step.
- **Next.js, Vercel, Cloudflare** stack: robust tooling and feedback loops for strong agentic traction.
- **Product ownership**: rapid prototyping, requirements gathering, defining and prioritizing the work, and verifying output against deployed previews on behalf of a non-technical user base.

Co-founder & Fractional CTO

Building Humane Technology | June 2025 - Present | Remote (part-time)

Scope: technical direction and roadmap for a public benefit corporation's engineering team.

- Originated and co-architected HumaneBench.ai, an open-source AI evaluation framework built on AISI Inspect.
- Fractional CTO to the team that built and maintains it, shaping architecture, scoring design, multi-provider support, documentation, and positioning.
- Designing and building a real-time evaluation classifier that scores AI behavior against those standards inline at sub-100ms.
- Designing telemetry for operational visibility and evaluation feedback loops.
- Curating the technical roadmap: production monitoring, multi-turn evaluation, adoption maturity models.

Co-founder & Software Engineer

Alchemy Astrology (formerly Mirror Astrology) | Nov 2024 - Jul 2026 | Remote

Scope: co-founder; owned front-end and design delivery, including outside design contractors.

- Owned the front end of a production consumer subscription app: Rails views, JavaScript, HTML/CSS, Tailwind, responsive UI/UX.
- Led design and UX delivery: worked directly with freelance designers, translated Figma into the Rails framework.
- Collaborated on the back end: Rails MVC, Stripe subscription billing, SSO authentication.
- Partnered with co-founders on product direction, roadmap, and prioritization.

Infrastructure Engineer
Tobiko | Mar 2024 - Oct 2024 | Remote

Scope: cloud platform serving production customer workloads.

- Architected and implemented a cloud platform serving customer workloads at an early-stage startup. Python, Pulumi, GCP, GKE, Cloud Run, Helm.
- Built CI/CD primitives the rest of engineering used: mono-repo conditional workflows, workload identity federation, continuous delivery.
- Stood up a customer support and incident response workflow, and onboarded staff and customers onto it.

Engineering Manager / Principal Software Engineer
Mavenlink / Kantata | Apr 2017 - Dec 2023 | San Francisco, CA

Scope: hired as a Senior Software Engineer, leading teams within a few months, and promoted to Principal for the infrastructure turnaround. Led two engineering teams for close to seven years, including the shared infrastructure platform relied on by every engineering team in the company. Partnered with product, security, and application groups on standards adopted organization-wide.

- **Internal Infrastructure Platform** (4 yrs): Built a new team from scratch whose product was the platform the entire engineering org built on, and ran it as a service org with internal customers: consulted with teams on their workflows, triaged requests, and turned recurring one-off asks into shared primitives and self-serve tooling so teams could ship without waiting on us. Owned the roadmap while staying hands-on in code, architecture, and review.
- Led the multi-year modernization of that platform from legacy infrastructure to cloud-native: the whole Rails monolith and its service ecosystem onto Kubernetes with Terraform and Ansible, the primary MySQL database onto RDS, and HashiCorp Vault stood up as an internal secrets service.
- Rebuilt the team after mass departures: inherited a one-person DevOps team and rebuilt hiring, onboarding, documentation, and on-call practice into a stable team with strong developer relations.
- Led a transition team that took ownership of the BI/analytics pipeline and migrated it to Kubernetes.
- **M-Bridge Integration Platform** (2.5 yrs): Took over an unreliable agent-based integration platform connecting the SaaS to customer systems (Salesforce, HRIS, accounting) and led its rearchitecture into a dependable one. Cut error rates roughly 100x by instrumenting the system and fixing what the data pointed at. Executed a zero-downtime migration from Heroku to Google Cloud (GKE and Cloud SQL), including relational, document, and cache stores.
- Shipped React features in the customer-facing product and worked in its Redux state management, alongside the platform and infrastructure work.
- Grew multiple junior engineers into senior SWE and Engineering Manager roles; led interviewing and hiring. Top Performer Award, 2021.

Lead Developer, Co-founder
Pegg | 2014 - 2017 | San Francisco, CA

- Designed, architected, and built a cross-platform mobile app from scratch for iOS and Android. Node.js backend, JavaScript frontend with Redux state management, Firebase real-time systems, CI/CD to AWS/CloudFront via CircleCI.
- Established the engineering workflow from nothing (pair programming, automated testing, CI, rapid deployment) and co-led product strategy, monetization, and launch planning.

Earlier Career (2001 - 2014)

Full-stack consulting and lead roles in Ruby on Rails, Node.js, and D3 (OpenTest Pro, Turnbull & Asser e-commerce). Introduced automated testing and CI at OnForce. Architected the initial release of mynewsletterbuilder.com and built its dev team at JBA Network.

OPEN SOURCE PROJECTS

Scan MCP (2024 - Present): MCP server giving AI agents control of document scanners. Privacy-first architecture, device discovery, JSON Schema validation, stdio and HTTP transports. TypeScript/Node.js. github.com/jacksenechal/scan-mcp

HumaneBench (2024 - Present): Open-source LLM evaluation framework built on AISI Inspect. See Building Humane Technology above. Python. github.com/buildinghumanetech/humanebench

SKILLS

- **Languages & Frameworks**: Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, React, Vue, Node.js, Ruby on Rails, Bash, HTML, CSS, Tailwind.
- **Front-end**: responsive design, UI/UX collaboration with designers, Figma handoff.
- **Back-end & Data**: API design, microservices, distributed systems, PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, Stripe, SSO/auth.
- **AI/LLM**: LLM evaluation frameworks (AISI Inspect), MCP servers, chatbot development, prompt engineering, context augmentation, agentic coding workflows.
- **Infrastructure & CI/CD**: AWS, GCP, Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, Pulumi, Ansible, Helm, GitHub Actions, CircleCI, infrastructure as code, automated testing, TDD.
- **Leadership**: Team building, hiring, coaching and mentoring, roadmap ownership, org change management, stakeholder engagement.

EDUCATION

BA in Mathematics, minor in Computer Science
University of North Carolina at Asheville | May 2003

- Graduated with distinction in Mathematics. Undergraduate research in 4D fractals.

RECOMMENDATIONS

“Jack is an exceptional engineer and leader. He strives to deeply understand the technology he’s working on while remaining cognizant of the socio-technical components that may be a factor in any project. He’s thorough, detail-oriented, and outcome-oriented, which means the solutions he architects, builds, and collaborates on come out better. Jack also strives to be at the forefront of new technology and assess how he can leverage it. Newer tech like GenAI can be complex and ever-evolving, and Jack is not one to back down but step up and embrace. He does all this with a strong team mentality, is a phenomenal team player, and can effectively delegate to help lift others’ skill sets.”

— Brandon Clifford, Director of DevOps, Kantata

“Jack has had quite a profound impact on my career. As a young engineer, I was fortunate enough to work with Jack as my coach. He served as a great mentor, helping me build both technical and professional skills and forming me into the engineer that I am today. Throughout our time together, Jack was caring and invested in helping me set goals and develop my career. His mentorship was a key factor in elevating myself from an incoming Junior Engineer to an Engineering Manager. Jack has a great curiosity and a strong set of technical capabilities that allow him to serve as a great example for others and a key contributor to any team!”

— Wesley Morlock, Engineering Director, Kantata

“Jack is a fantastic engineer always ready to help solve problems and more importantly, teach you how to solve them. He guided me and my team through a bunch of challenging GitOps situations with patience and kindness, leading by example. Always diligent with his work, willing to roll up his sleeves to get things done and find creative solutions.”

— Cesar Palafox Garza, Principal Software Engineer, Kantata

See additional recommendations on LinkedIn